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Digital Leisure

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Touched By Tech

Ergonomics At Work

Improve your typing safety and performance—use ergonomically designed keyboards and mice

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Have you ever used a gently sloped keyboard that gives you better comfort while typing? Ever noticed how the ergonomic design lets you place your hands, wrists and forearms in a natural position for greater comfort?

Ergonomics entails matching the design of physical devices to the needs and characteristics of the human body. The term is derived from the Greek words 'ergon', meaning work, and 'nomoi', meaning natural laws—in other words, the study of any man-machine interface, whether physiological or psychological. Keyboards and mice that take ergonomics into consideration are designed to be as comfortable as possible. They increase

productivity, reduce operator fatigue, and improve the work environment.

Edging Towards Ergonomics

Ergonomics is becoming increasingly important in the design and use of computer peripherals. Most conventional keyboards cause painful and even permanent injuries to the spine, fingers, neck and wrist joints. 'Overuse' injuries and cervical spondylitis are some of the persistent hazards associated with poor computer ergonomics. Hence, most ergonomic key-

boards aim to get the hands and wrists in the right position.

Keyboard makers have developed a variety of alternative, ergonomic keyboard designs to improve work performance for users, protect them against Repetitive Stress Injury (RSI) and thereby bring down professional hazards to a minimum.

Moninder Jain, country manager, Logitech India, says, "Comfort is usually a personal

